CPT COMBAT & PERFORMANCE TRAINING · MELBOURNE

CANINE PERSONAL TRAINING SYSTEM

10-SESSION FOUNDATION TRAINING SYSTEM WITH 1–3 WEEKS OF HOMEWORK BETWEEN SESSIONS DEPENDING ON PROGRESS

01	02	03	04	05
MOVEMENT MECHANICS	VISUAL ENGAGEMENT	VERBAL COMMUNICATION	MOTIVATIONAL DRIVE	ENVIRONMENTAL STABILITY

DEVELOPED BY SOTIR KICHUKOV

CPT — Canine Personal Training. A structured 10-session foundation system designed to build communication, motivation, confidence and reliable daily obedience in dogs and their handlers.

CPT — CANINE PERSONAL TRAINING

FOUNDATION SYSTEM

PURPOSE OF THE CPT FOUNDATION SYSTEM

We are developing the CPT — Canine Personal Training 10-Session Foundation System. This is a structured programme designed to build clear communication, confident behaviour, strong motivation and a positive relationship between dogs and their handlers. The program contains 10 coaching sessions with 1–3 weeks of homework between sessions depending on progress, suitability and the pace of the individual dog.

MOVEMENT MECHANICS

Movement creates connection. Dogs learn how to follow the handler's body, understand position changes and improve coordination, balance and flexibility. This includes forward and backward stepping and pivots.

VISUAL ENGAGEMENT

Focus creates clarity. Dogs learn to maintain visual engagement with the reward source, track movement and redirect attention when requested. Source focus is required for Contact Heel, and Contact Heel is required for Street Heel.

VERBAL COMMUNICATION

Clear communication builds understanding. Dogs learn that commands, markers and transitions have consistent meaning, helping them respond with confidence and willingness.

MOTIVATIONAL DRIVE

Motivation creates willingness. By developing each dog's natural drive in a structured way, training becomes more engaging, rewarding and easier to maintain across different environments.

THE 5 OFFICIAL CPT PILLARS

PILLAR	FOCUS	TRAINING APPLICATION
1. Movement Mechanics	Body awareness, coordination, positioning, pivots and leash control.	Develops the dog's ability to understand and follow the handler's movements while improving balance, precision and control.
2. Visual Engagement	Source focus, visual tracking, attention, concentration and switching focus.	Teaches the dog to engage with the reward source, track movement and redirect attention when requested.
3. Verbal Communication	Verbal commands, reward markers, release cues, timing and consistency.	Builds a consistent communication system that helps the dog understand what is expected and when the task is completed.
4. Motivational Drive	Food drive, ball drive, toy engagement, enthusiasm, drive switching and drive control.	Develops enthusiasm and responsiveness while teaching the dog to transition between higher-energy activities and calmer behaviours.
5. Environmental Stability	Socialisation, confidence, adaptability, mental stimulation and application of learned skills in different environments.	Builds confidence and calmness in new environments, with gradual exposure to people, animals, sounds and real-world situations.

DEFINITION OF LURING

Luring: A reward-based training technique using food or toys to direct a dog into specific positions and movements.

PHASE 1: DRIVE, HANDLING SKILLS & LEASH HEEL

SESSION 1

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Goal: Build food drive, engagement and reward source focus without forcing eye contact. Establish a clean motivation base before formal obedience is introduced.

- **Food Drive Ignition:** Use kibble or highly valued food in a quiet environment to build motivation and encourage the dog to move toward the reward source.
- **Magnet Hand:** Hold treats in the hand and move the hand backward so the dog follows and stays engaged with the handler.
- **Opposition Reflex:** Pull the reward slightly away to encourage the dog to move forward and commit to the chase or follow.
- **Focus on the Reward Source:** Allow the dog to look at the food, toy or target without requiring forced eye contact.

Daily practice: 2–3 sessions, 5–10 minutes	**Mix exercises from Session 1 only until the next session is booked**

SESSION 2

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Goal: Build source focus, hand-to-food communication and clear transitions between activities. Develop reward switching and maintain engagement with the handler.

- **Source Focus:** Source focus is the ability of the dog to channel his energy onto the reward and wait to be released or redirected once he understands the concept. Reward the dog for pausing on the food or toy without demanding eye contact with the handler.
- **Switching Focus:** Use the marker and reward sequence to reset the dog and redirect attention back to the handler.
- **Break Marker:** Introduce a clear break or transition cue to signal the end of one activity and the start of another. The same word can be used for switching focus and ending the exercise.
- **Handling Mechanics:** Practise hand movement, positioning and timing so the dog understands the intended movement without confusion.

Daily practice: 2–3 sessions, 5–10 minutes	**Mix exercises from Sessions 1 and 2 until the next session is booked**

SESSION 3

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Goal: Introduce Contact Heel and body awareness using luring and guided movement patterns. This session develops coordination, heel positioning and the dog's understanding of working around the handler.

- **Contact Heel:** Introduce heel contact at the handler's side with source focus, forward and backward stepping, and pivots.
- **Position Shaping:** Use luring to guide the dog into Sit, Down and Stand with smooth transitions.
- **Figure-Eight Movement:** Teach the dog to move around the handler in tight patterns while maintaining a stable heel and clear body position.
- **Directional Changes:** Practise turning left and right while the dog stays connected and focused on the handler.

Daily practice: 2–3 sessions, 5–10 minutes	**Mix exercises from Sessions 1–3 until the next session is booked**

SESSION 4

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Goal: Introduce Street Heel, lure fading, duration, free shaping and leash skills. This session begins the transition from highly guided exercises into more relaxed everyday handling.

- **Street Heel:** Use the same heel position as Contact Heel for calm, everyday walking without requiring continuous source focus.
- **Lure Fading:** Begin fading out the physical lure and replace it with clearer handler motion and body cues.
- **Duration:** Build short stays in Sit, Down and Stand while the dog remains calm and responsive.
- **Free Shaping:** Reward natural choices the dog offers that move closer to the desired behaviour.
- **Leash Skills:** Practise turning, halting, loose-leash walking and following the handler without tension.

Daily practice: 2–3 sessions, 5–10 minutes	**Mix exercises from Sessions 1–4 until the next session is booked**

PHASE 2: BALL DRIVE, REWARD SWITCHING & RECALL

SESSION 5

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Goal: Build controlled balance between motivation and handler direction. Teach the dog to enjoy rewards and movement while being able to switch back to the handler.

- **Ball Drive:** Introduce moving ball or toy-based play to increase enthusiasm and engagement.
- **Drive Switching:** Use the marker, reward, or break cue to redirect the dog back to handler focus from play.
- **Reward Swap:** Teach the dog that returning to the handler unlocks the next reward, whether food, a toy or movement.
- **Calm Return:** Encourage a controlled return rather than a chaotic recoil from the reward source.

Daily practice: 2–3 sessions, 5–10 minutes

Mix exercises from Sessions 1–5 until the next session is booked

SESSION 6

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Goal: Increase confidence and focus in more distracting environments while staying under the dog's threshold.

- **Front-of-House Exposure:** Practise in calmer outdoor areas before progressing to busier locations.
- **Loose-Leash Drills:** Maintain connection and control when distracting sights, sounds and movement are present.
- **Distraction Response:** Reward calm focus and recovery when sudden triggers appear.
- **Stability Check:** The dog should remain responsive without reactivity or losing the handler's position.

Daily practice: 2–3 sessions, 5–10 minutes

Mix exercises from Sessions 1–6 until the next session is booked

SESSION 7

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Goal: Build recall confidence and create a reliable response to the handler under excitement or distance.

- **Recall Foundations:** Practise short recall sequences with the reward source close enough to succeed consistently.
- **Long-Line Recall:** Increase distance gradually while keeping the dog engaged and moving toward the handler.
- **Reward Timing:** Reward the correct recall immediately to build association between returning and success.
- **Finish in Position:** End successful recall with a calm sit or front position before release.

Daily practice: 2–3 sessions, 5–10 minutes

Mix exercises from Sessions 1–7 until the next session is booked

SESSION 8

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Goal: Improve drive control and emergency responsiveness during higher excitement, while keeping the dog calm and responsive to handler cues.

- **Emergency Down:** Practise dropping to a calm down from excitement while remaining under control.
- **Prey Call-Off:** Use the break or transition marker to redirect the dog away from a moving toy or prey-like stimulus.
- **Controlled Release:** Release the dog back to the activity only when calm and under control.
- **Drive Control:** Use the dog's engagement without overwhelming the dog emotionally or physically.

Daily practice: 2–3 sessions, 5–10 minutes

Mix exercises from Sessions 1–8 until the next session is booked

PHASE 3: SOCIALISATION, CAFES & GRADUATION

SESSION 9 — PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Goal: Develop environmental stability, confidence and calm behaviour in real-world settings without forcing interactions. This includes socialisation, confidence-building and maintaining emotional neutrality around other dogs and people.

- **Neutral Socialisation:** Walk past other dogs and people at a distance where the dog can stay relaxed and responsive.
- **Cafe Settle:** Practise calm stationary behaviour in a dog-friendly café or outdoor seating area without greeting strangers.
- **Confidence Exposure:** Gradually build the dog's ability to stay settled in new environments while using the handler as the anchor.
- **Environmental Stability:** Includes socialisation, confidence, adaptability, mental stimulation and applying learned skills in different environments.

Daily practice: 2–3 sessions, 5–10 minutes	**Mix exercises from Sessions 1–9 until the final assessment**

SESSION 10 — FINAL ASSESSMENT

Goal: Perform a final public environment assessment in a realistic setting to confirm the dog's training readiness, handler confidence and ability to maintain calm behaviour under everyday challenge.

- **Public Environment Walkthrough:** Practise loose-leash walking, controlled movement, sit and down responses and calm transitions in a public area.
- **Noise & Movement Exposure:** Maintain performance with environmental distractions present without losing focus.
- **Recall in Public:** Demonstrate the ability to return promptly and calmly to the handler.
- **Graduation Criteria:** Demonstrate reliability, calmness, responsiveness and a stable working relationship between dog and handler.

Daily practice: 2–3 sessions, 5–10 minutes	**Mix exercises from Sessions 1–10 to maintain and consolidate skills**

HANDLER CODE OF CONDUCT

1. **Say it once and guide smoothly.** Avoid repeating the verbal cue unnecessarily. Timing and body language matter more than volume.
2. **Assess both ends of the leash.** If the exercise fails, review both handler timing and dog readiness before increasing difficulty.
3. **Keep the environment realistic.** Train under conditions the dog will actually face in daily life and build confidence gradually.
4. **Reward clarity and calmness.** Success is created through consistency, patience and positive reinforcement.

OFFICIAL TRAINING LOG

Track individual practice sessions and note handler mechanics for Coach Sotir to review during progress audits.

SESSION	CORE MILESTONE	TARGET CRITERIA	HANDLER FIELD NOTES	DONE	SIGN
1	Food Drive & Reward Source	Motivation and focus without forced eye contact		☐	
2	Source Focus & Switching	Clear transitions and calm focus		☐	
3	Contact Heel & Positioning	Contact Heel with pivots and forward/backward stepping		☐	
4	Street Heel & lure fading	Street Heel, duration, free shaping and leash skills		☐	
5	Drive Switching	Controlled enthusiasm with calm handler focus		☐	
6	Distraction proofing	Response in new environments without reactivity		☐	
7	Recall foundations	Reliable response to recall under movement		☐	
8	Drive control	Calm recovery and emergency response during higher excitement		☐	
9	Public socialisation	Confidence in new environments and around people/dogs		☐	
10	Final assessment	Reliable real-world obedience and handler partnership		☐	

CPT FOUNDATION CERTIFICATION

Official recognition by CPT coach upon completion of the 10-session foundation system.

Sotir Kichukov / Date